

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
Ecosystems Division – Marine and Freshwater Branch – Source to Sea Pollution Unit**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Nairobi, Kenya
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Environment

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Ms. Heidi Savelli-Soderberg
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Chief, Source to Sea Pollution Unit

3. Background information

The United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) is the United Nations system's designated entity for addressing environmental issues at the global and regional level. Its mandate is to coordinate the development of environmental policy consensus by keeping the global environment under review and bringing emerging issues to the attention of governments and the international community for action. The Source-to-Sea Pollution Unit of the Marine and Freshwater Branch, Ecosystems Division, supports Member States to protect the marine environment from land-based activities through strengthened coordination of global action. The Unit addresses in an integrated way major pollution streams that are affecting the marine environment: wastewater, nutrients, plastic pollution and marine litter, physical alteration and destruction of habitats (PADH). The Unit also provides secretariat services to three global

partnerships, including the Global Partnership on Plastic Pollution and Marine Litter (GPML), the Global Wastewater Initiative (GWWI) and nutrients (Global Partnership on Nutrient Management – GPNM).

The Unit is currently implementing the UNEP Programme of Work (PoW) project “Preventing and addressing the degradation of freshwater and marine ecosystems from source to sea” which is enhancing responses to the land-based pollution of the marine environment, including by strengthening partnerships, stakeholder engagement and communication.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

- Providing support to Member States in identifying solutions to challenges related to land-based activities.
- Supporting the implementation of activities related to wastewater, nutrients, plastic pollution and marine litter, physical alteration and destruction of habitats (PADH).
- Contributing to strengthening partnerships, stakeholder engagement and communication for the Source to Sea Pollution Unit, including the private sector, development banks and agencies, financial sector, innovative entrepreneurs, sub-national and local governments, and CSOs (especially related to gender, youth, and indigenous people).
- Prepare, finalize and provide inputs to project budgets, assessments, articles, stories, drafts, publications, background documents, presentations, policy briefs, briefing and concept notes, reports, aide memoires, outreach, and other material.
- Support and/or lead the organisation of outreach activities such as webinars, workshops, and other events.
- Support the organisation’s fundraising efforts, as well as coordination and initiative with Member States and other relevant stakeholders.
- Support the reporting from the perspective of partnerships, communication and stakeholder engagement.
- Provide and consolidate inputs and facilitate the exchange of information among colleagues.
- Participate in team meetings online when present at Duty Station and represent the unit online, at the duty station and in external meetings as required.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree in environmental management, international relations, sociology, geography, geology, climate issues, agriculture, hydrology or related fields or equivalent studies and a good understanding of interdisciplinary issues related to society culture and environment.

Work experience

A minimum of one year of progressively responsible experience in environmental management and related fields is required. Previous experience in an international organisation is desirable.

Languages

English and French are the working languages of the United Nations Secretariat. For this job opening, English is required. Knowledge of another United Nations official language is desirable.

Other skills

- Willingness for teamwork and good communication skills.
- Basic computer skills, including MS word and excel.
- Good common sense, cultural skills for respect and integration

Competencies

PROFESSIONALISM: Good understanding of women's rights, gender equality and empowerment of women; Accumulated professional competency in project management; Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of gender mainstreaming; Shows pride in work and in achievements; Conscientious and efficient in meeting commitments, observing deadlines, and achieving results; Motivated by professional rather than personal concerns; and shows persistence when faced with difficult problems or challenges.

COMMUNICATION: Speaks and writes clearly and effectively; Listens to others, correctly interprets messages from others and responds appropriately; Asks questions to clarify, and exhibits interest in having two-way communication; Tailors language, tone, style and format to match the audience; Demonstrates openness in sharing information and keeping people informed.

PLANNING AND ORGANIZING: Develops clear goals that are consistent with agreed strategies; Identifies priority activities and assignments, adjusts priorities as required; Allocates appropriate amount of time and resources for completing work; Foresees risks and allows for contingencies when planning; Monitors and adjusts plans and actions as necessary; Uses time efficiently.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

Providing support to Member States in identifying solutions to challenges related to land-based activities. The will fellow will also develop a solid understanding of technical issues related to wastewater, nutrient management, plastic pollution and marine litter, as well as the physical alteration and destruction of habitats (PADH). The Fellow will gain experience in requesting and analyzing substantive inputs, assessing project proposals, and providing inputs to project documents and budgets in line with UN standards. The Fellow will learn how to develop, implement, expand partnerships and monitor campaigns and projects with better organizational skills. They will also acquire skills in formulating job descriptions and monitoring project implementation progress.

Through this assignment, the Fellow will deepen their knowledge of the UN system, build professional contacts within and beyond the UN, and strengthen their ability to work effectively in a multicultural environment while becoming familiar with UN rules and regulations. In addition, the Fellow will be able to contribute to, prepare, or lead outreach and capacity development activities, and gain exposure to indicator methodologies supporting relevant Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

The Fellow will be briefed on the first few days on the activities of the office and respective departments.

- Written goals and objectives will be included in a working plan, built together with his/her team. • His/her work plan will be discussed and agreed upon.
- A monthly activity report is expected during the period of fellowship. A progress report is also expected during the weekly science team meetings.
- The fellow is expected to be able to deliver an update on any assignment under his/her care whenever asked.
- The fellow will also get regular feedback, guidance, and support.
- An overall evaluation will be carried out quarterly.

8. Living conditions in the country

The area of assignment offers generally conducive living and health conditions. Basic goods and services are readily accessible, with well-functioning local markets and reliable public transportation.

The socio-economic and cultural environment is diverse, offering opportunities for rich intercultural experiences. The duty station is considered secure, with tight security arrangements in place. The climate is generally mild, ranging from cool to warm throughout the year.